

Using social media is injurious to health. But the young will adapt

Cigarettes and social media, it is now becoming clear, have quite a bit in common. Both are **addictive**, **put out** by huge corporations that make massive profits from them. The difference — **perhaps** fortunately — is that it has taken much less time to realise that the latter is “injurious” to health. Earlier this week, a committee of 50 experts asked the Spanish government to place **caps** on smartphone use by **minors** and have pop-up warnings for certain apps. In France, too, there have been calls for such action and in June, the US Surgeon General Vivek Murthy demanded that social media carry tobacco-like warning labels.

The **disenchantment** with social media has been remarkably quick. It took more than a century from when the first commercial cigarette-making machine was **patented** in 1844 in Mexico to the first packets carrying health warnings in the US in 1966. **By contrast**, the oldest social media site is the now-**defunct** Six Degrees, launched in 1997. It is **arguably** only with the **advent** of high-speed internet in the late 2000s that the beast we know today first **bared its fangs**. One reason for this is the political impact social media has had — as a campaign tool, it has been widely used and **often, maligned** globally but especially in the US. The more clear and present danger, though, is the impact it has on mental health, particularly of young people.



Behind the calls for warnings is a more fundamental question: How do you **deal with** addiction? As any smoker will **attest** to, once **hooked**, the warnings rarely act as a **deterrent**. However, studies have shown that they help in reducing the number of “new” **addicts**. There’s also another factor that policymakers — most of them, at their youngest, are old **millennials** — may not understand about a generation born as “digital **natives**”. The young are not so **restless** about social media as their elders — and more **adept at navigating** its dangers.

Vocabulary

1. **Injurious** (adjective) – Harmful, damaging, detrimental, deleterious
हानिकारक
2. **Adapt** (verb) – Adjust, modify, become accustomed, acclimatize अनुकूल होना
3. **Addictive** (adjective) – Habit-forming, dependence-inducing, compulsive, ensnaring आदत लगा देने वाला
4. **Put out** (phrasal verb) – Produce, release, issue, publish जारी करना
5. **Perhaps** (adverb) – Maybe, possibly, conceivably, potentially शायद
6. **Cap** (noun) – Limit, ceiling, restriction, upper boundary सीमा
7. **Minor** (noun) – Underage individual, child, youngster, adolescent नाबालिग
8. **Disenchantment** (noun) – Disillusionment, disappointment, dissatisfaction, disillusion निराशा
9. **Patent** (verb) – Obtain a patent, register, secure intellectual property rights
अधिकार सुरक्षित करना
10. **By contrast** (phrase) – In comparison, on the other hand, as opposed to this, conversely इसके विपरीत
11. **Defunct** (adjective) – No longer functioning, obsolete, discontinued, extinct बंद पड़ा हुआ
12. **Arguably** (adverb) – Possibly, conceivably, it can be argued, arguably तर्कसंगत रूप से
13. **Advent** (noun) – Arrival, coming, onset, emergence आगमन
14. **Bare one's fangs** (phrase) – Reveal one's true harmful intentions, show aggressiveness, expose menace अपनी हानिकारक मंशा दिखाना
15. **Often** (adverb) – Frequently, regularly, repeatedly, commonly अक्सर
16. **Malign** (verb) – Defame, slander, speak ill of, disparage दुष्प्रचार करना
17. **Deal with** (phrasal verb) – Handle, manage, address, cope with निपटना
18. **Attest** (to) (verb) – Confirm, testify, bear witness, affirm पुष्टि करना
19. **Hook** (verb) – Capture interest, ensnare, catch, entrap लत लगाना
20. **Deterrent** (noun) – Discouragement, restraint, check, preventive measure निवारक

21. **Addict** (verb) – Make dependent, habituate, cause to rely, enslave आदी बनाना

22. **Millennial** (noun) – A person born approximately between early 1980s and mid-1990s/2000s 1980-2000 के बीच जन्मा व्यक्ति

23. **Native** (noun) – Local, originally from there, someone born into a certain environment स्थानीय

24. **Restless** (adjective) – Uneasy, agitated, unsettled, anxious बेचैन, अशांत

25. **Adept** (at) (adjective) – Skilled, proficient, expert, accomplished निपुण

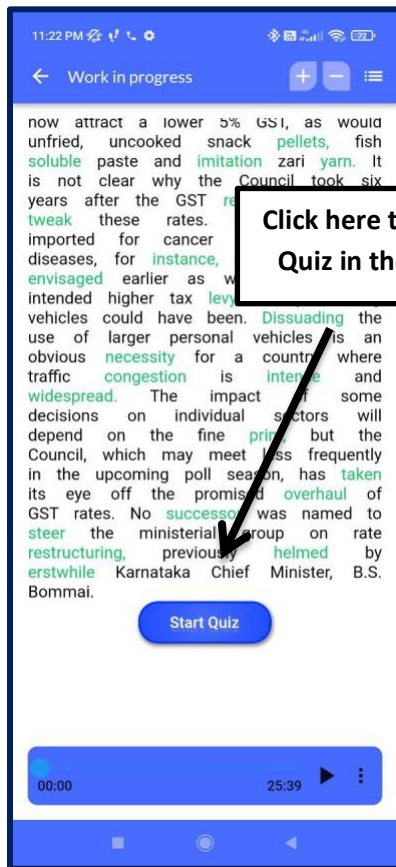
26. **Navigate** (verb) – Find one's way, move through, steer, deal with complexity रास्ता निकालन

@mocks_wallah

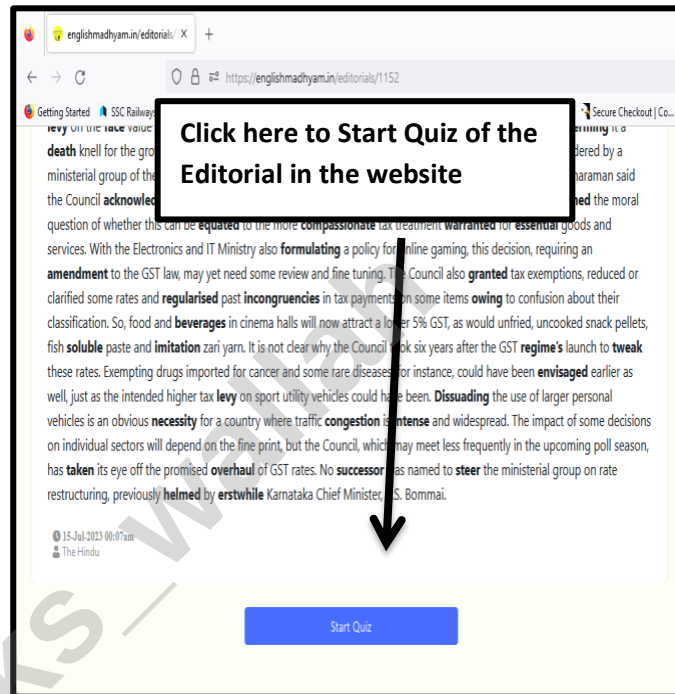
Summary

1. Social media is increasingly being seen as harmful to health, similar to cigarettes.
2. Both are addictive and driven by corporations that make huge profits.
3. Unlike cigarettes, awareness of social media's dangers has come much faster.
4. Experts in Spain have recommended restrictions on smartphone use for minors.
5. France and the US have also pushed for warning labels on social media.
6. The rise of social media has been rapid, starting with Six Degrees in 1997.
7. High-speed internet in the late 2000s accelerated its widespread impact.
8. Social media's political influence has contributed to its criticism.
9. A major concern is its negative effect on young people's mental health.
10. The key challenge is how to address social media addiction effectively.
11. Warnings may not stop current users but could prevent new addicts.
12. Policymakers struggle to understand the digital-native generation.
13. Unlike older generations, young people are more comfortable with social media.
14. They are also better at handling its risks than older generations assume.
15. The debate continues on how best to regulate and mitigate social media's harms.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



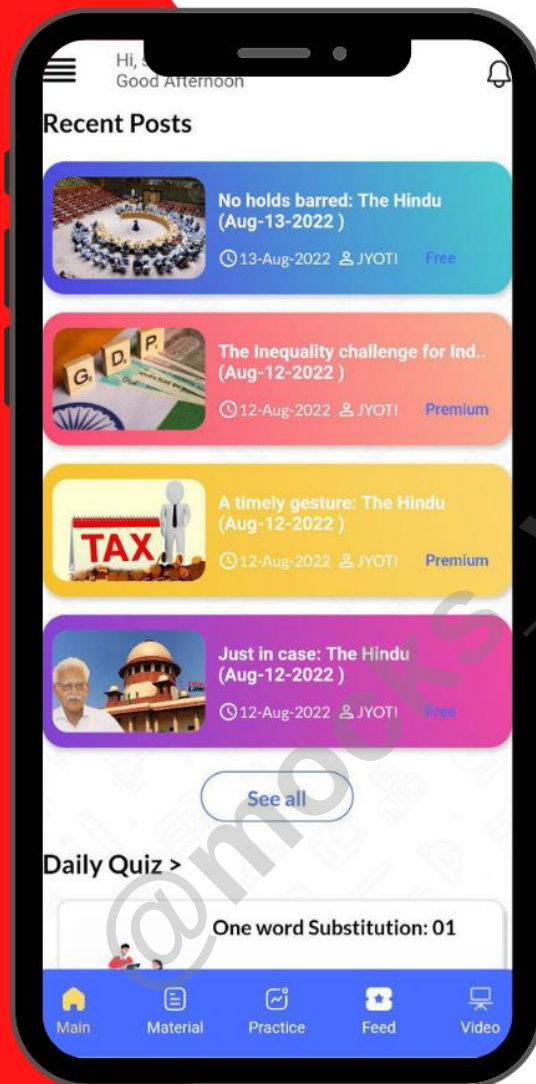
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